

Azure Storage and Database Cost Optimization Guide

This fictional reference provides retrieval material for storage accounts and Azure SQL resources. Recommendations must be validated against resilience, regulatory, and recovery requirements.

Storage lifecycle and redundancy

Storage cost depends on access tier, redundancy, retained versions, snapshots, and transaction volume. Select protection levels that match the workload rather than a universal maximum.

- Move rarely accessed blobs from Hot to Cool or Archive through lifecycle management after confirming retrieval and latency needs.
- Review LRS, ZRS, GRS, and RA-GRS selection against business continuity requirements; higher redundancy increases cost.
- Expire temporary files, old diagnostics, and superseded blob versions using lifecycle rules.
- Monitor transaction and egress costs because access-pattern changes can outweigh capacity savings.

Azure SQL capacity review

Database recommendations depend on workload utilization, service tier, storage use, high availability, and licensing. Review actual demand before changing a production tier.

- For predictable production use, evaluate reserved capacity after confirming the database will remain in service.
- For intermittent non-production workloads, assess serverless or scheduled pause options where supported.
- Review long-term backup retention, geo-redundancy, and inactive databases for avoidable storage cost.
- Use tags for cost center, environment, and owner to make shared database spend accountable.

Dummy scenario

democostarchive is a Standard_LRS StorageV2 account in the Hot tier. A lifecycle policy should be evaluated for archive data. democost-sql is a production SQL server that should be assessed from observed utilization rather than immediately downgraded.